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ROOTING FOR GREEN COOLING SYSTEMS

Roadside conversations with makers of bamboo and vetiver curtains. **P4**



DEPARTED FOR ANOTHER SANCTUARY

V. Guruswami leaves behind a flock of admirers in naturalist circles **P5**



Vehicles heading towards Sardar Patel Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A dangerous bend at Madhya Kailash

Speed-calming measures are needed on this busy section

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

On June 3, three accidents occurred within 45 minutes on Rajiv Gandhi Salai, along Sardar Patel Road in Adyar. In one of the incidents, a car swerved left to avoid hitting a female pedestrian, and a man was caught between the two cars. A speeding vehicle literally drove towards a woman.

Tamil Nadu Road Development Company (TNRDC) should install speed breakers at this spot, say pedestrians.

S. Sundaram, a pedestrian, says, "The motorists come at a clip, and the pedestrians find it difficult to cross the road. Some motorists prevent pedestrians from entering the carriage-way by driving too close."

The left turn (towards Sardar Patel Road) is a blind curve, preventing pedestrians from seeing motorists. Pedestrians can only see the motorists approaching them at the last minute. Introducing any speed-calming mea-



asures would help.

T. Krishnan, a pedestrian, says, "Greater Chennai Traffic Police (GCTP) has put up a board stating that the left turn is an accident-prone zone and advises motorists to go slow, but caution is thrown to the wind. Other safety measures like zebra crossing lines and speed breakers should be created."

The speed breakers will also help prevent vehicular accidents. Motorists over

speed and drive close to one another when turning, and in the melee, collisions can occur.

K. Chithra Kannappan, a pedestrian, says, "Most motorists are aware that pedestrians cross the area, yet they do not slow down or halt. GCTP should have installed signage indicating a 'Pedestrian Crossing Area' and advising motorists to reduce their speed near the curve.

Bookworms, marshes and metaphysics

The Federation of OMR Resident Associations (FOMRRA) Book Club is hosting its highly anticipated meetup today on 14 June (from 3:30 p.m. to 6:30 p.m.) at Casagrand Amethyst Community Party Hall in Sholinganallur.

The meetup features an interactive conversation with OMR-based author Renu Chhotaria to discuss her book *Ram Naam Satya Hai...* A New

Beginning. The fictional work explores the life of Sanjana who takes a deep dive into Ramayan and decodes them with care and sensitivity.

The event also features a deep dive into Delia Owens' *Where the Crawdads Sing*. This discussion also holds profound relevance for the residents of OMR as most of us live surrounded by the fragile ecosystem of the Pallikaranai marshland. Just as the novel explores who-

dunnit set amidst the intricate beauty, life and isolation of the marshlands, today's session will also discuss the urgent local need to protect and save the Pallikaranai marsh from urban encroachment.

Attendees are also invited to FOMRRA's 21st Book Swap where you can bring a book and take a book! For more information connect with bookworms on <https://BookWorms.FOMRRA.org>

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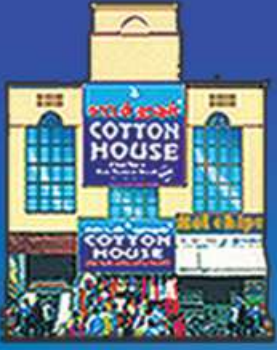
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READERS WRITE



Laxity in ABC programme?

Sholinganallur resident wants humane methods to keep stray dog population in check, implemented diligently

ANAND SHANKAR

At Kumaraswamy Nagar park and nearby streets at Ward 197 in Zone 15 (Sholinganallur), a sizeable pack of stray dogs (around 20) are found, and they clearly have not spent any time at the ABC centre. And whether they have had a rabies shot anytime is a moot point. And these thoughts naturally send shivers down the spine of parents watching their children play at this park.

These dogs urinate in the soil at the park where children play and also where the gym equipment are located. Elders go for a stroll in this space. And both these constituencies are susceptible to infections, one on account of an immune system yet to develop fully and the other by virtue of a weakened immune system. Many parents avoid going to this park along with their children.

Even at our apartment, Lancor TCP Altura on Model School Road, quite a number of stray dogs sneak in despite the security. Years ago, we would see vans picking up dogs for sterilisation at an ABC centre located at the entrance of Model School Road, and those vans rolling into our streets, and that correlates with the noticeable rise of stray dog population in these parts in

Over the past year, many of my neighbours and I have noticed increasing incidents of dog bites (including unprovoked attacks on pedestrians and children), frequent night-time barking and traffic disruptions caused by packs on busy roads. These issues are compounded by inadequate waste management, which provides food sources that sustain large stray populations.

Many residents, especially the elderly and children, now avoid walking in certain areas.

I suggest the following

measures:

Strengthen and expand the ABC-AR (Animal Birth Control – Anti-Rabies) programme with adequate funding and transparent reporting of sterilisation and vaccination targets and outcomes.

Create scheduled mobile vaccination/sterilisation camps in identified hot-spots and maintain a publicly accessible database of operations and progress.

Improve municipal waste collection and community awareness to reduce deliberate and accidental feeding that sustains large packs, including placing secure bins and clearing open dumps promptly.

Addressing this issue humanely is essential. Sterilisation, vaccination, public education and solid waste management are proven, sustainable strategies.

(Anand Shankar is a resident of Lancor TCP Altura at Model School Road in Sholinganallur)



At a park and a street in Kumaraswamy Nagar, Sholinganallur

Get your clothes redyed at this event in Besant Nagar today

Tula Organic Clothing, a not-for-profit, is conducting various events at Spaces, Elliots Beach Road, Besant Nagar, on June 14; 10 a.m. onwards.

There will be live demo and hands on workshop of Tula's wholistic value chain covering ginning, hand spinning, weaving, natural dyeing, block printing, crochet, eco printing, hand painting and mending. The sessions will be covered by experts and artisans associated with Tula, said a release.

Shoppers can bring their gar-

ments and get them (re)died or get eco printing or hand painting done. One can also buy new kora fabric or garments.

Tula Organic Clothing (www.tula.org.in) stocks garments from Indian cottons, organically grown by smallholder, rainfed farmers, with the yarn hand spun by khadi workers and coloured with natural dyes, added the release.

Registration is a must to participate in the workshops.

For details, call 80561 63560/ 98947 81318

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Chennai cannot do without air-conditioners, but their run time can be reduced if one designed their living space green and topped it with soft furnishings that have the visible imprint of nature. Here are roadside conversations with makers of bamboo and *vetiver* curtains

Rooting for green cooling systems

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At the time of writing this (for the times-tamp-obsessed: the afternoon of June 11), the sun has been served a memorandum of suspension for its obnoxious behaviour in the past few days. An overcast sky has ensured the fiery orb stays out of work. Clearly a reprieve from what was an unusually harsh beginning to June, generally known as the pre-monsoon season even in the sun's long-held fiefdom, Chennai. Just as a lioness would deal an overly exuberant cub a surprise paw swipe, the joy could be short-lived for the Chennai people. Put it down to climate change, the weather has the vacillating mind of a Hamlet, and so it can be hot again before you know it. And it might not be too late still to "insulate" your house with cost-effective, heat-reducing traditional props. In any case, the benefits would carry over to the next summer and the ones beyond.

Here is a cherrypicked solution, one lying under one's feet. It is curtains made of *vetiver* (*chrysopogon zizanioides*), an aromatic perennial grass native to India that comes with an air of reverence, its fragrant roots occupying the front row in pujas. Off the religious altar, it is patronised for its cooling properties. When woven into curtains, *vetiver* comes into its own. A recommendation not to be ignored: *vetiver* curtains (also known as *khus* curtains) can be teamed with bamboo curtains for coverage of greater surface area, factoring in cost, the former taking a slightly oversized bite out of the wallet, and maintenance, the former again being the difficult one.

Why these nature-based solutions, NbS as they call them? This poser needs to be put to those who make a livelihood out of making these curtains. Enter S. Jagadeeshwaran and Nagarajan, who along with their teams, work by the roadside in Alwarpet and Adyar respectively, ironically soaking up the sun to help



people stay shielded from it.

With some assistance, a *vetiver* curtain can cut out the heat to some extent. Jagadeeshwaran explains that sprinkling approximately half a litre of water on the *vetiver* screens every morning and evening helps maintain a cool atmosphere, while the moist roots release a natural earthy aroma. "*Vetiver* stands out not just for its cooling properties but also for its herbal and medicinal benefits," says Jagadeeshwaran, owner of the family-run Jagadeeshwaran Bamboo Works on TTK Road. Jagadeeshwaran makes *vetiver* curtains too.

With a life span of approximately two years and costing

around ₹200 per square foot, *vetiver* curtains, says Jagadeeshwaran, can be an ally in keeping the sun in check. Let us not hoodwink ourselves into the outrageous, even hare-brained idea that *vetiver* or for that matter bamboo can replace technology-based cooling systems (aka fans and air-conditioners).

Along with sustainable design of the house, these natural curtains can reduce the use of air conditioners, thereby resulting in savings on the power bill. But the house has to be prepared for them. They would fare better in a house with a generous provision for cross-ventilation. They do not so much cool a space as

keep unwanted stuff such as too much sunlight and pollutants out of it. Having said that, the water-sprinkled *vetiver* curtains do bring in a whiff of cool air, but only so much.

Their environmentally friendly nature should be a strong incentive to pair them with tech-based cooling solutions.

Bamboo versus *vetiver*

Nagarajan, a maker of bamboo as well as *vetiver* curtains in Adyar (near the Aavin parlour park) is a believer in *vetiver* curtains, but tends to bat longer for bamboo curtains. From a design perspective, bamboo curtains stand out. With those roots, *vetiver* curtains can resemble the inside of an angler's worm box. In contrast, the neat lines of the bamboo strips, horizontal, vertical or cross-stitched, make the curtains aesthetically more pleasing.

"Available in a range of colours and finishes, bamboo curtains can complement different architectural styles while helping lower indoor temperatures" Nagarajan adds. Then, the cost equation. Nagarajan notes bamboo is also the more economical option, costing around ₹100 per square foot, against the price of ₹200 per square foot *vetiver* curtains come at. He adds that bamboo products are particularly popular among resorts, hotels and homeowners looking to combine functionality with visual appeal, whereas *vetiver* curtains are predominantly preferred by individual households seeking a traditional cooling solution. With electricity tariffs ever on the rise and heatwaves becoming more stinging, Chennai residents should not ignore these traditional options. Beyond being money-wise, this would signify a return to a sustainable practice that was once the norm, and now takes an article such as this to remind ourselves of their continuing relevance.

S. Jagadeeshwaran can be contacted at 9841565239/9003183916 and Nagarajan at 9941538328.

'Building design key to effectiveness of bamboo and *vetiver* curtains'

Architect and co-founder of Design Co Lab, Pavithra Sriram on when these traditional curtains, which she clubs among "materials that breathe", can be effective:

"The curtain system itself, whether it is a *vetiver* curtain or a bamboo curtain, is the last step of this entire spectrum. You are looking at a building that has to be designed in such a way that there is cross ventilation. Unless you do that, your reliance on air-conditioners is not going to stop. One *vetiver* curtain in an extremely developer-built apartment that lacks cross ventilation cannot suddenly make for Ooty climate. The entire building needs to respond to the local context. It is important not to look at these things as topical, band-aid solutions. They need to be understood as part of a holistic approach. The entire building environment has to work together. When that happens, elements such as bamboo curtains, *vetiver* screens and other traditional materials can play a meaningful role in improving comfort and reducing dependence on mechanical cooling systems."

Departed for another sanctuary

V. Guruswami leaves behind a flock of admirers in naturalist circles

PRINCE FREDERICK

In the morning of June 11, if any birder in the field noticed a sudden drop in chirps verging on stillness, let them know that these birds sensed an instinctive snapping of a tie, the departure of a soul that sought to understand them selflessly. Not to make it to scientific journals and put on learned airs; nor to engage in social-media engagement farming. In their world, he discovered his own, one devoid of artificiality and filled with effortless comfort.

That morning, V. Guruswami departed for another sanctuary. A long life (he was 96), one spent with a great degree of autonomy (he bounced back to full health after a stroke in the fag end of 2011 and was in fine fettle till the last week of his life) is certainly a measure of blessing. But what was truly Guruswami's blessing was his ability to bless others with his knowledge, unconditionally without expecting anything in return. He leaves behind a flock of friends

(nay more admirers than friends) at Madras Naturalists Society, a repository of local naturalist wisdom. But anyone who has known him beyond birding field visits would instantly resist the temptation to pigeonhole him into the identity of a naturalist-birder.

The breadth of his knowledge was indisputably vast. To give an inkling, he could hold forth on the legendary kite flyers of Madras in the 1940s and in the same breath share the contents of his correspondence with Jim Corbett. He was rooted locally, deeply connected with the twin *jheels* (Manali and Madhavaram) as well as the verdant Simpson Estate in Sembium (all of them close to his former address in Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar), but he had a global consciousness, always sharpened by a desire for knowledge, again not acquired for self-aggrandisement but to freely share with others.

His curriculum vitae would indirectly reveal how he went out of his way mining for knowledge in various fields.

"Guruswami was born on Sep-



V. Guruswami (September 25, 1930 - June 11, 2026), truly erudite and incredibly humble.

tember 25, 1930, studied at CSI Kellet Higher Secondary School in Triplicane and graduated with a chemistry degree from Presidency College, Madras. He started working with the Ordinance Factory at Khamaria, Jabalpur, later moved

to Addison Paints at the Simpson Estate in Sembium where he joined as a chemist and retired as a production manager."

That note is oddly familiar; one comes across that kind of a bio all the time; only that this one is silent

on an extra universe of pursuits. Silent on reams and reams on the koel vocalisation, listening in to the male koel's plaintive calls during the breeding season, year after year.

Silent on the incredible conservation story at the Simpson Estate, where he helped protect a heronry. Silent on the trends of various bird species he had documented and shared with journalists including this reporter. And silent on the numerous notes on the drift of things in various other fields he had penned, just for his delectation and those known to him. Unfortunately, much of this information was lost in the shifting of addresses. When he was advanced in years (in the early 2010s after his almost-magical recovery from the stroke) Guruswami and three other seniors in the family took the decision to move from Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar to a senior-friendly block of an apartment in Sholinganallur with the support of the younger relatives in the family. Guruswami remained unmarried, and enjoyed a deep connection with his family, immediate and extended, and he was the favourite uncle and grandpa, no contests there.

And it was in this space on June 11, Guruswami breathed his last, nay let out his last chirp, not far from the Pallikaranai marsh synonymous with winged residents and visitors.

Weaving a livelihood for the visually challenged

Lit The Light Trust, in association with Voluntary Health Services in Taramani, has launched a livelihood project to support the visually challenged who are adept at wire chair canning

LIFFY THOMAS

Lit The Light Trust, a Chennai-based non-profit known for connecting the visually challenged with scribes, has embarked on a livelihood project in wire chair canning.

Launched recently with the support of various organisations, the project seeks to give visually challenged adept at wire chair canning a leg-up.

To start with, 10 visually challenged persons drawn from various areas of Chennai are being offered advanced skill development and work opportunities.

Barath SN, founder, Lit The Light Trust, says the biggest hurdles faced by these weavers are: getting work orders and difficulty in travelling to a customer's place to undertake the work.

Both these concerns have been addressed by Lit The Light Trust. "Voluntary Health Services (VHS) Multi Speciality Hospital in Taramani has a space by the name 'Centre for Visual Rehabilitation'



Volunteers and beneficiaries during the inaugural event.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

where we can undertake training and design fresh chairs with wires," says Barath.

The plan is to make this space at VHS a one-stop point for this project. The Trust will be procuring raw materials that the visually challenged can work on from the premises.

"They would also be happy to go to homes for repairs or recanning and the payment can be made directly to them. We are only the

bridge helping them get work and market the products made by them," says Barath.

The larger goal is to ensure the visually challenged get a steady source of income. The plan is to induct more such visually challenged into this livelihood project and find other trades that can be scalable. "Some are seen seeking alms in trains and public places as they do not have a regular source of revenue that we want to discourage by



getting them work," he says.

Sixty-one-year-old M. Elango, a visually challenged weaver for the last 35 years, says some of them are associated with the Physically Challenged Welfare Cooperative Society in Guindy through which they get work. "I am ready to travel from my home in Arumbakkam to places around to take up work," he says. His request to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay is to allot the work of recanning chairs at government

offices to visually challenged so that they have a reliable source of income. The Trust is getting ready to make wire bags so that it can be given as return gifts on special occasions. "We see a market for that and with the corporates we are in touch we could promote such gifts," says Barath.

Cook India Medical Devices Pvt. Ltd helped the Trust under its CSR project. To place an order, call 9894212102

A second chance for everyday things

As a two-day garment mending workshop by Samposhan ends today, a close look at Chennai's repair culture provides cause for some celebration and also reasons to revitalise efforts to promote it

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Wire it right

At a time when malfunctioning appliances are often discarded with little thought, Repair Café Chennai is championing an alternative ethos, one that prioritises repair and recirculation.

Launched in October 2024 by Meenalochani S, founder member of Repair Café Chennai, the initiative traces its roots to the Repair Café movement started in Bengaluru by Purna Sarkar. The first Chennai session was held in the portico of Meenalochani's home, bringing together friends and their children for a hands-on introduction to repairing everyday objects. "It felt very much needed for every child as part of the skills they should grow up with," says Meenalochani.

The inaugural event featured stations for carpentry, cycle repair, and electrical and electronic repairs. Over time, however, the Chennai chapter evolved into a series of workshops focused primarily on

electrical and electronics repair. "The electrical and electronics section caught up with us because we found good mentors for it who were willing to continue the journey," she says. "My daughter got to open up the devices and identify the problem herself. Now she knows electronic goods can be repaired instead of simply buying new ones," says one of the participants.

Since then the collective has conducted workshops with a school in Besant Nagar, collaborated twice with Goethe Institute, and organised sessions in public spaces across the city. Most participants have been homeschoolers, with some families travelling from Puducherry



During a session at Repair Cafe Chennai.



Operating from his main outlet near Thirumangalam in Anna Nagar, with branches in Mogappair, T. Nagar, Ambattur and Padappai, Aasai Muthu restores saris damaged by age, wear and accident. Torn fabrics, damaged borders, colour bleeding caused by rainwater, rodent-inflicted damage and faded hues are among the most common problems brought to his workshop.

The craft is a "hand-me-down" to Aasai Muthu. "My grandfather and father were both weavers. From childhood, I was surrounded by saris and weaving work," he says. "Even now, I can easily identify different types of zari and borders."

His clientele ranges from homemakers seeking to preserve treasured possessions to actors and other prominent personalities. Wedding silks and heirloom saris account for a significant portion of the work he undertakes, particularly from customers in Mylapore. "Many people bring saris that belonged to their mothers or grandmothers. They do not want to throw them away because there are memories attached to them," he says.

Restoration charges typically range from ₹500 to ₹2,000, depending on the complexity of the work involved. While the repair itself generally takes three to four days, the entire process extends to six to eight days, including approximately two days each for collection and delivery. Customers may either visit the workshop or schedule a home visit, during which Muthu personally assesses the sari's condition. As part of the service, every restored sari is returned with a complimentary dry-cleaning treatment, helping revive its appearance and finish.

One of the more unusual assignments he recalls involved a government official who wanted the border from one sari painstakingly removed and attached to another. Such requests, he says, underscore the sentimental value that many customers continue to place on their garments.

Yet, Aasai Muthu has observed a gradual decline in the culture of repair. "Nowadays, many people prefer to sell old saris and buy new ones. Earlier," he says. The challenge becomes even greater when dealing with saris that are decades old. "Repairing a sari that is 30 or 40 years old requires a lot of patience. We cannot bring back the original material completely, but we can restore it and make it wearable again," he says.

Call Aasai Muthu at 6380563972

to attend repeatedly.

Through pre-registered sessions lasting three to four hours, participants learn troubleshooting, continuity testing, soldering and basic appliance repair under the guidance of volunteer mentors.

Fees range from ₹500 to ₹1,000.

The initiative also sustains an active WhatsApp community where participants seek repair advice and share resources. Looking beyond workshops, the group is working to build a gig-employment network connecting skilled repairers with those seeking repair services. "Our mission is to create earning opportunities, empower skilled workers, and connect them with people who need reliable repair solutions," says Meenalochani.

Instagram - @repaircafe.tiruandchennai

Stitching memories

When a treasured sari is torn, faded or damaged, Chennai-based sari repairer Aasai Muthu is often the person customers turn to.

With over 45 years of experience, Muthu has built a niche business around restoring saris that hold sentimental, cultural and monetary value.

The last day of a restoration workshop

Samposhan, the sustainability enterprise based in Adambakkam and founded by Mamta Jain, has brought together environmental consciousness and creativity through a two-day mending workshop in Besant Nagar. Titled "Pause. Mend. Reuse.", the event (June 13 and 14) encourages participants to repair and reimagine worn garments, extending their lifespan while underscoring Samposhan's broader mission of reducing textile waste and promoting a circular economy. Through hands-on sessions, attendees learn mindful mending techniques and explore ways to give cherished pieces a new lease of life, demonstrating how a simple repair can be a small but significant act of sustainable living.

Instagram - @thesamposhan





Pandian at his newspaper mart in Besant Nagar.

Pandian latches on to his magazine store despite dwindling sales

Betting big on print

PRINCE FREDERICK

No, Pandian does not follow Insta trends that romanticise the tactile of physical books, the incredible idea of holding thoughts in your hand before dropping them into your brain. Putting it in grander terms, the sacred union of the sensory and the cerebral. He does not canonise physical books writing digital hagiographies to them and canonising them into sainthood through posts on social media handles. No book apps to his name; not a single one. In fact he does the unthinkable: he carries no phone with him. When a quizzical brow running the gamut of questions (why, how come, why not, since when?) is directed at him, his answer is unhurried and accompanied by a gesture (palms covering his head): “The mobile phone is a headache”. He says that in Tamil.

Who is this “mystery man” Pandian anyway? His bio at the press of a button, nay the flipping of pages.

Seventy-five years old. Formal education ending with Class VII. A resident of Keshavaperumalpuram South in R.A. Purim. His work space is in Besant Nagar, at the cusp of Besant Avenue Road and Second Besant Avenue Road, the space lying strategically on the path to the Besant Nagar bus terminus. He is modest to a fault, caring a hoot about winning people over with appearances: his work flannels are just a banian paired with a dhoti. But he ends up winning people over with a quiet confidence, even unintended chutzpah, the courage to not bend oneself to trends. He displays all of these by holding on to what is now a 45-

year-long metier and title: seller of magazines and newspapers. He has retained the visible symbol of this engagement, a newspaper and magazine mart, the eponymous ASP Newspaper Mart, stubbornly staying put in its corner despite progressively decreasing footfall. The establishment is modest: an old, pushcart painted in blue shaded from the shine and rain with a corrugated metal sheet and tarpaulin. By the side of the cart, stand two slanting paper and magazine metal racks.

The collection of magazines is as ambitious as the establishment is spartan. The Hollywood Reporter; Vogue; Conde Nast Traveller; Autocar; TopGear; Outlook Traveller; Entrepreneur; Brides Today; Frontline; Architecture + Design; Dalal Street Investment Journal and so on. There are English, Tamil, Malayalam and Hindi magazines and newspapers. “After the pandemic, sales had been on a low. People who read magazines are in a decline. There are some old people are left. Gen Zs go abroad (yes, he used the descriptor Gen Z),” states Pandian, not in a rueful tone, but in a manner that suggests dispassionate reporting. But that has not caused him to do a rethink about the business. To questions about financial viability of this enterprise, he points out he does not bother about it at all, just sells those newspapers and magazines; and a few other items (disposable razor, tongue cleaner and so) that “rats cannot get at”. And he seems to sell just enough to keep the show going. His self-identity is incredibly entangled in the notion of a newspaper seller, and he cannot disentangle himself from it without causing a dent in his self-worth.

Real estate firm conducts celebratory event

Tirthanighai Real Estates recently celebrated its annual ‘Kudumba Vizha 2026’ in the city.

Held at MCC School auditorium in Chetpet, the festival brought together the firm’s channel partners, employees, business associates, and their families for an evening dedicated to recognition and inspiration.

Founded by K. K. Mu-

niyanti, the organisation’s chairman, the nearly four-decade-old firm has built a strong reputation on trust.

Muniyanti reiterated the organisation’s long-standing vision that every family should own a piece of land.

A major highlight at the celebration was the recognition of channel partners, team leaders, marketing managers, and

employees through a series of awards and documentary-style presentations that showcased their success stories.

The leadership team comprising K. K. Munusamy, S. Arun Kumar, K.M. Srinivasan, and K.M. Hariharan unveiled upcoming residential projects under the Tiru Thanikai Infra City and shared the organisation’s vision for the future.

Anna University library conducts user awareness programme on ONOS

The University Library of Anna University, in association with INFLIBNET Centre, organised a User Awareness Programme on *One Nation One Subscription (ONOS)* recently to familiarise researchers, faculty members and students with the national initiative aimed at expanding access to scholarly resources, says a press release.

Welcoming the participants, Prof. V. Jeyalakshmi, Director of the University Library, highlighted the significance of ONOS in strengthening the research ecosystem and enhancing scholarly productivity.

The press release notes that the technical sessions were conducted by Abhishek Kumar, Scientist-D (CS) and V. Raja, Scientist-F (CS), both from INFLIBNET Centre, Gandhinagar. The sessions covered ONOS, INFED (INFLIBNET Access Management Federation), IRINS (Indian Research Information Network System) and various services offered by INFLIBNET, providing participants with practical insights into accessing and utilising the resources effectively.

The valedictory address was delivered by Prof. P. Hariharan, Dean, CEG Campus, Anna University. He also distributed certificates to more than 100 participants representing institutions from various states across India.

ONOS, an initiative of the Government of India, seeks to democratise access to knowledge and research by providing Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) across the country with seamless access to scholarly literature. Through centralised subscriptions negotiated with nearly 30 major international publishers, including Elsevier, Springer Nature and Wiley, the programme offers access to more than 13,000 journals spanning science, technology, engineering, medicine, humanities and social sciences, says the press release.

The resources are accessible through institutional campus IP networks and remotely via the INFED Access Federation established by INFLIBNET. Users can access the content from any device, including mobile phones.

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On the garbage beat in an **outlying area**

Composting can spare these workers the nausea of working with extremely mucky and smelly waste



PRINCE FREDERICK

At Muttukadu on East Coast Road, the front-opening garbage bin has its mouth ajar, about to puke its smelly contents. Those contents are more tightly packed together than occupants of a rush-hour elevator. But that is not even half attention-worthy as what follows. The garbage has to be transferred to a tractor-hauled roofless goods carrier. The mixed waste has been in the bowels of the bin for three days. Out comes a casuarina pole to hold the shutter open. A bedsheet is spread in front of the open garbage bin. On it is plonked an aluminium container. With what looks like a shrub rake, clumps of waste are clawed and pushed into the container. The process is repeated. And when the spillovers in the bedsheet are sizeable, the bedsheet is held by two and the mucky contents thrown into the carrier.

The one supervising this work points out that in Muttukadu panchayat, garbage bins are placed on ECR and in the side streets. The bins are cleared by turns, each in three days, the time it apparently takes for a bin to get filled to the brim.

Two thoughts climb out of that bin, elbowing away the garbage. One, can't these workers have the benefit of slightly better technology, probably not a



Grabage clearance at Muttukadu panchayat

heavy truck-mounted hydraulic compactor, but something better that what they have at their disposal now?

And two, should not waste segregation and composting at site be followed more stringently in these circumstances? The greater human contact should be the prod driving the initiative to ensure decomposing biodegradable waste is dealt with right where it is generated. ECR is lined with nurseries, the sale of compost generated by residents to these nurseries is an option.

Fiftieth show of Gopi Funchurian

Popular actor, mimicry artist, and stand-up comedian Badava Gopi will be celebrating the 50th performance of "Gopi Funchurian", a unique stand-up comedy and mimicry show, on June 20 at 7 p.m. at the Music Academy.

Unlike other conventional stand-up comedy sessions, this will offer entertainment for the whole family, said a release.

The 90-minute show will feature

humour, mimicry, storytelling, sound effects, celebrity voice recreations, cricket-inspired moments, and amusing

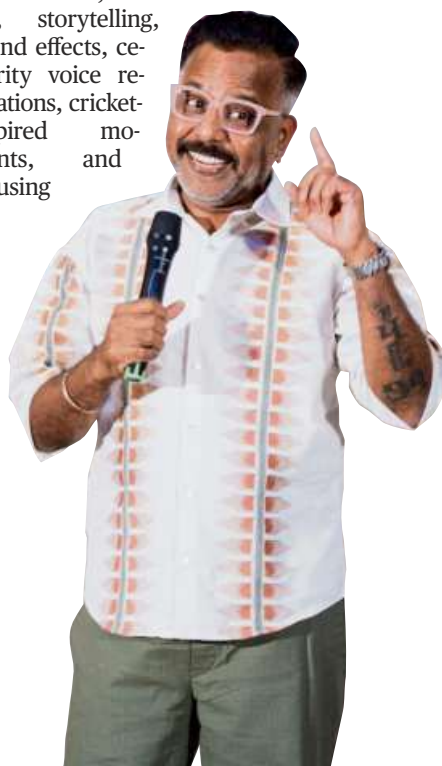
real-life incidents from Gopi's life journey.

In a release, Badava Gopi said, "Mobile phones and YouTube videos cannot recreate the energy, laughter, and atmosphere that audiences experience live watching Gopi Funchurian. The show is to be felt, and enjoyed together as a family."

The 90-minute show will start at 7 p.m. Tickets are available on BookMyShow.

For details, call 9962886000

Website: www.badavagopi.com





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